



The Wright Flyer (as it came to be known) was made from spruce wood.

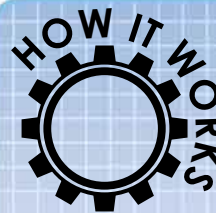
How it changed the world

The invention of the airplane made traveling across the world a lot easier. Only four decades after the first powered flight, flying machines were blasting into space.

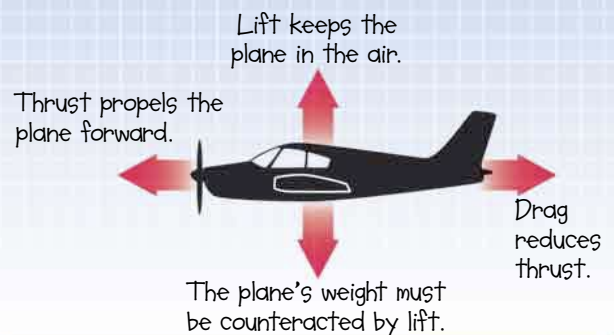


Modern-day flying

The Wrights' plane used a gasoline engine that turned **propellers**. The invention of more powerful **JET ENGINES**—usually situated on the wings—made big, passenger-carrying aircraft possible. People could then jet off on flights to the other side of the world, reaching destinations that would have taken *months by sea*.



Thrust from the engine drives the plane forward, and the plane's shape lets air flow around it with minimum drag. The weight of the plane pulls it downward, and must be overcome by lift. This is provided by the way air moves around the wings.



The **HARRIER JUMP JET** was the first vertical takeoff plane. It first flew in 1966.

American astronaut **NEIL ARMSTRONG** stood on the Moon after **ROCKETING INTO SPACE** in 1969.

